Ethical Challenges in Generative AI Misuse

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Abstract

Generative artificial intelligence (AI) misuse is the improper use of generating text, videos, images, software code, data, and music. This paper looked at the ethical dilemmas in regard to generative AI misuse. The ethical dilemmas that were included were privacy and academic integrity and misconduct, which affected both individuals and communities. Generative AI misuse was best looked at from a utilitarian ethical framework. From an utilitarian perspective, it determined right from wrong. This paper continued to look at the stakeholders involved with generative AI misuse. Students, professors, teachers, and individual users were all identified throughout. The research hit on the importance that each should be informed about. The study continued to solutions, which included clear guidelines to prevented generative AI misuse. The understanding of ethical dilemmas, stakeholders, and solutions helped to demonstrate the importance of how generative AI could be used in a more responsible and safer way from a utilitarianism point of view.

Keywords: Generative Artificial Intelligence, Misuse, Solutions, Ethical, Unethical, Stakeholders

Ethical Challenges in Generative AI Misuse

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is becoming something that people rely on heavily on an everyday basis. It can help with a number of things including generating videos, essays, short text, and images (Stryker & Scapicchio, 2025). Generative AI is a something that raises ethical issues but can also be very helpful at times. The issues that come with generative AI misuse add to what is right and wrong. The ethical dilemmas, stakeholders, solutions to privacy are all things that should be considered when talking about generative AI misuse. The impact on individuals and communities is high. Understanding what ethical dilemmas come with this and being able to identify them is essential to creating and considering solutions to help with generative AI misuse.

What is Generative Artificial Intelligence Misuse

Generative artificial intelligence (AI), also known as gen AI, is a type of AI that can generate text, images, videos, music, software code, and synthetic data (Stryker & Scapicchio, 2025). This form of AI can be useful at times, but it can also be misused. It is crucial to understand what is ethical when it comes to the proper use and the misuse. Misuse occurs when privacy is invaded, dishonesty happens, and its harmful and unethical (The Ethical Dilemmas of AI, 2024). Examples of generative AI misuse include using personal and sensitive information without permission and encouraging any sort of academic integrity or misconduct (AI In Schools: Pros and Cons, 2024). Knowing what is right from wrong, proper and misuse, helps avoid any problems and makes sure that generative AI is being used properly.

Ethical Dilemmas

When talking about generative AI misuse this creates many ethical dilemmas that can affect both individuals and communities. A way to analyze generative AI misuse is through the ethical framework of utilitarianism. Utilitarianism distinguishes what it right from wrong (Ethics

Unwrapped, 2023). One of the major ethical dilemmas is privacy. Often AI systems acquire a lot of sensitive and personal information (The Ethical Dilemmas of AI, 2024). The issues with this are all the collecting and using personal information without getting permission from the user. The right thing here would be getting permission from the user. Without user permission to sensitive and personal information this creates a lack of control within the system, which can lead to serious harm and misuse of information. Another ethical dilemma is artificial intelligence (AI) in education (The Ethical Dilemmas of AI, 2024). This is one of the main dilemmas that will continue to raise questions about using AI in schools and universities across the world. Many students today have access to generating and completing assignments with AI. This heavy reliance on AI can create academic dishonesty, misconduct, and inaccurate information (AI In Schools: Pros and Cons, 2024). All the growing questions and concerns continue to show that generative AI has to be used with care, not only to prevent the misuse of it, but to protect individuals and communities privacy, academic integrity, and prevent academic misconduct.

Stakeholders

There are several stakeholders when talking about generative AI misuse. Many people are affected by this but in different ways. Students, professors, and individual users are the main group affected here and should take the time to weigh the pros and cons of it. Students need to understand that they can face many issues with academic integrity if they rely on artificial intelligence for everything. Professors at universities, or even just teachers are impacted because it's becoming harder for this to distinguish what is artificial intelligence and what is actually the students work. Individual users outside of schools are affected because again if their personal information is misused without permission, this becomes a problem (Warrior, 2025).

Solutions

Various solutions can help with generative AI misuse and protect individuals and communities. One of the main solutions to this includes universities creating clear guidelines for how it can and should be used. According to the office of communications from University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (2024), when students and professors are able to fully understand what is right from wrong, it becomes easier to prevent this and helps encourage proper use of generative AI. Another solution includes enhancing the privacy of individuals. You should be careful and sensitive about what information you put into any artificial intelligence system. Giving the necessary information will not harm anything but always ensure that it is needed. Lastly, many companies and corporations are continuing to create tools that are able to detect any misuse. According to Stryker and Scapicchio (2025), tools are being created to detect any deepfakes or marked AI generated content. This will help with preventing false information from being spread and reduce any generative AI misuse. All of these solutions align with coming from a utilitarian point of view because they reduce misuse and help to increase benefits of actually using generative AI properly.

Generative artificial intelligence (AI) is continuing to grow across the United States every day. It can be very helpful at times but comes with many pros and cons. The misuses of generative AI can affect many individuals and communities. It is important and crucial that you understand the ethical dilemmas, stakeholders, and the solutions to preventing the misuse from happening. By taking the time to understand the things that come with generative AI misuse, individuals and communities can use generative AI in a more responsible way and prevent the misuse that comes with it.

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